





How West Marches Play Works

One safe home base

The hearth-town of Kettleford is where each session starts and ends. The notice board gives choices, but the Guide only needs one chosen quest ready.

- Pick one notice from the board.
- Ask the party which route they take.
- Run three exploration turns.
- Bring everyone home before bedtime.

Step	Question
1. Look	What do the Adventurers notice in the art or map?
2. Choose	Careful, normal, or brave shortcut?
3. Meet	Creature, clue, weather, or local helper?
4. Mark	Add a sticker, path, friend, danger, or treasure to the map.

West Marches rule: no quest is mandatory; players choose the next notice.



PRINTABLE QUEST NOTICE BOARD

Cut out or pin this page

Lost Bell at Moon Loch

Reward: Moon-water vial. Route: reeds and stepping stones. Danger: worried kelpie foal.



Red Wax on the Toll Gate

Reward: Bridge-Friend badge. Route: south road. Danger: tax-mage echo.



Goat Bell in Storm Cairn

Reward: cairn goat bond. Route: high path. Danger: oath thunder.



Longship Lantern

Reward: sea-token map. Route: north coast. Danger: draugr oath.



Fox Map in Thistlewood

Reward: safe route mark. Route: bramble path. Danger: redcap bargain.



Potion Garden Rescue

Reward: heatherheart draught recipe. Route: bog edge. Danger: sleepy nightshade jam.



QUEST: LOST BELL AT MOON LOCH

Scenes

- Meet Fia the kelpie foal at the wet stones.
- Follow silver bubbles through a reed maze.
- Open the humming gate with a promise.

NPCs

- Fia: scared but brave if praised.
- Auntie Reed: slow, formal, hates grabbing.
- Bubble-Nose Trout: wants to be paid in compliments.

Encounter

Rising water makes choices urgent. Rope, song, stepping stones, or animal friendship all work.



QUEST: RED WAX ON THE TOLL GATE

Scenes

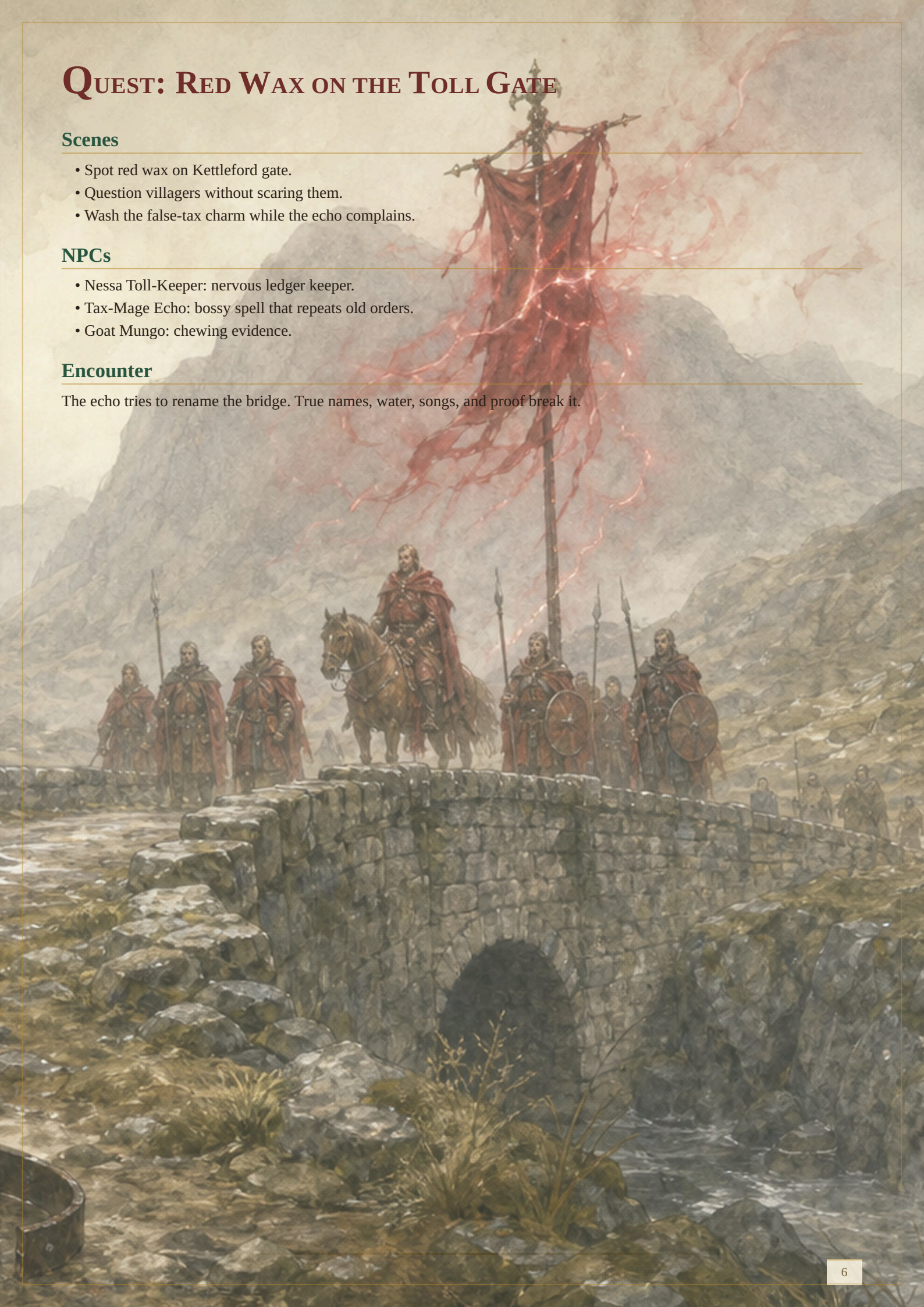
- Spot red wax on Kettleford gate.
- Question villagers without scaring them.
- Wash the false-tax charm while the echo complains.

NPCs

- Nessa Toll-Keeper: nervous ledger keeper.
- Tax-Mage Echo: bossy spell that repeats old orders.
- Goat Mungo: chewing evidence.

Encounter

The echo tries to rename the bridge. True names, water, songs, and proof break it.



QUEST: GOAT BELL IN STORM CAIRN

Scenes

- Climb heather hills in wind.
- Hear thunder answer wrong promises.
- Return the bell to a cairn goat without waking the wight.

NPCs

- Pebblehorn Goat: stubborn, hungry, honorable.
- Old Duthac: poet guide.
- Cairn Wight: scary but fair.

Encounter

Hold a cloak rope, speak an oath, and choose whether to bargain or sneak.



QUEST: LONGSHIP LANTERN

Scenes

- Find a blue lantern on an empty longship.
- Trade clues at the harbor market.
- Carry the lantern to the sea cave before tide turns.

NPCs

- Torunn Wave-Smith: friendly trader.
- Skull-Sail Rurik: loud rival.
- Draugr Rowers: want oath finished.

Encounter

Fog, rowing sounds, and a rising tide. Peace, trade, and oath-work beat fighting.

